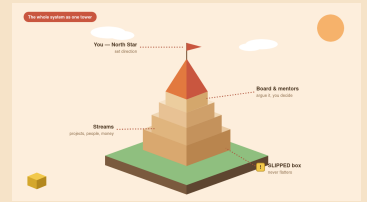


The Builder's Citadel

One organised home for your whole life's information — personal, practical, social, financial — that an AI can safely run for you.



WHAT THIS IS

A folder of notes and rules you hand to an AI assistant. Instead of your projects, people, money, deadlines and half-formed ideas living in your head, they live in one place an AI can work safely. It doesn't only store things — it acts. A brief in your inbox each morning, research done overnight, messages drafted in your own voice. Nothing is ever sent, deleted or changed without asking you.

THE ONE NEW IDEA (EVERYTHING ELSE IS JUST A CHAT BOX)

You've used a chat box before. The only new thing here is this:

an AI app can be handed a folder on your computer, and then it can read and write the files inside it for you.

GETTING IT RUNNING — FIVE STEPS, ABOUT 40 MINUTES

- 1 Unzip the folder and park it somewhere safe**
Double-click the zip file. Move the folder it creates into Dropbox, OneDrive or iCloud Drive — somewhere that keeps old copies of files. Don't leave it loose on the Desktop.
- 2 Install the Claude app — the app, not the website**
Go to claude.com/download and install it. This bit matters: the website can only see what you paste into it. The app is the one that can be given a folder. (The folder feature needs a paid plan.)
- 3 Open the app and point it at your folder**
Sign in. Start a Cowork session and choose the folder from step 1. It will ask permission to work in it — say yes. You only ever do this once.
- 4 Type three words into the chat box: Run SETUP.md**
That's genuinely it. It's an ordinary chat box, like any other. The difference is that it can now see your folder, so it knows what SETUP.md is and what to do with it.
- 5 Answer its questions**
It asks one at a time, mostly multiple choice, always with a 'let me type my own' option. Around 30 minutes. Stop whenever you like and pick it up later — it remembers where you got to.

NOT SURE YET? LOOK BEFORE YOU INSTALL ANYTHING

You can see the whole idea without an account, an app, or a penny spent. Just unzip the folder and:

- open `Citadel-Game.html` — it opens in your browser. Click a quest, watch the city grow.
- open `docs/assets/citadel-deep-dive.mp4` — five minutes, every part of the system explained.
- read `GUIDE.md` — the full manual, in any text editor or note app.

If none of that appeals, you've lost ten minutes and installed nothing. That's a fair test.

Once it's running

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Next morning: read your first brief, glance at the Tower, tick one thing off. That loop is the whole system — you don't have to use every part of it.

Prefer it as a game? Open `Citadel-Game.html` in any browser. Your first weeks are laid out as quests with points, streaks and a little city that grows each time you finish something. Nothing in it ever punishes you for a missed day.

Want it explained properly? In `docs/assets/` there's a 90-second intro video and a five-minute walkthrough covering every part of the system, one piece at a time.

WHY IT'S SAFE TO PUT REAL THINGS IN

- It always asks before sending an email, moving a file, or anything touching money.
- Automated emails may go only to addresses you approved out loud, and those lists can never cross over into each other. You add a recipient by saying so — never by writing it in a file.
- Text found inside a document is never obeyed as an instruction, so a file someone sends you can't quietly tell your AI to do something.
- Folders whose names start with `_` are locked. Files ending in `-noread` are never opened at all.
- Every session that changes anything writes a log entry, so you can check its work afterwards.

WHAT'S IN THE FOLDER

00-START-HERE.md	your first two minutes
CLAUDE.md	the rulebook your AI reads before it touches anything
SETUP.md	the one-time interview that builds your vault
GUIDE.md	the full manual, in plain English
Citadel-Game.html	your first weeks as quests — open it in a browser
01-Streams ... 13-Code	the numbered folders, one job each
docs/assets/	the videos and the diagrams

IF YOU GET STUCK

Ask the AI itself — in the same chat box. "I don't understand what a stream is" or "what did you just change?" are perfectly good questions, and it has the whole guide in front of it. Nothing here can break in a way that matters: keep the original zip, and you can always start over.